

058. Chapter 4 Verses 38-41

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 4.38

न हि ज्ञानेन सदृशं पवित्रमिह विद्यते ।
तत्स्वयं योगसंसिद्धः कालेनात्मनि विन्दति ॥ ३८ ॥

na hi jñānena sadṛśaṃ
pavitramiha vidyate |
tatsvayaṃ yogasaṃsiddhaḥ
kālenātmani vindati ||

- ◆ **na hi** – not indeed; **jñānena** – to knowledge; **sadṛśaṃ** – like/equal;
- ◆ **pavitram** – purifier; **iha** – here (in this world); **vidyate** – exists;
- ◆ **tat** – that; **svayaṃ** – himself; **yoga-saṃsiddhaḥ** – one perfected in Yoga;
- ◆ **kālena** – in time; **ātmani** – in the Self; **vindati** – finds/attains.

**Indeed there is nothing so pure as Knowledge in this world.
He who is perfected in Nishkama Karma finds that wisdom
by himself in Atma in due season.**

VERSE 4.39

श्रद्धावान् लभते ज्ञानं तत्परः संयतेन्द्रियः ।
ज्ञानं लब्ध्वा परां शान्तिमचिरेणाधिगच्छति ॥ 39 ॥

śraddhāvāṃllabhate jñānaṃ
tatparaḥ saṃyatendriyaḥ |
jñānaṃ labdhvā parāṃ śāntim
acireṇādhigacchati ||

- ◆ **śraddhāvān** – the man of faith; **labhate** – obtains; **jñānam** – knowledge;
- ◆ **tat-paraḥ** – devoted to it; **saṃyata-indriyaḥ** – who has subdued the senses;
- ◆ **jñānam** – knowledge; **labdhvā** – having obtained; **parām** – supreme; **śāntim** – peace;
- ◆ **acireṇa** – quickly; **adhigacchati** – attains.

**The man of faith, having Knowledge as his supreme goal
having controlled the senses, obtains knowledge of Atma,
and having obtained that enjoys everlasting peace.**

VERSE 4.40

अज्ञश्चाश्रद्धधानश्च संशयात्मा विनश्यति ।
नायं लोको ऽस्ति न परो न सुखं संशयात्मनः ॥ 40 ॥

ajñāścāśraddadhānaśca
saṁśayaātmā vinaśyati |
nāyaṁ loko'styaparo
na sukhaṁ saṁśayaātmanaḥ ||

- ◆ **ajñāḥ** – the ignorant; **ca** – and; **aśraddadhānaḥ** – the faithless; **ca** – and;
- ◆ **saṁśaya-ātmā** – the doubting soul; **vinaśyati** – goes to ruin;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ayaṁ** – this; **lokaḥ** – world; **asti** – is; **na paraḥ** – nor the next;
- ◆ **na sukham** – nor happiness; **saṁśaya-ātmanaḥ** – for the doubting soul

But the ignorant man, the faithless man, the doubting man goes to destruction. For the doubting self, there is no happiness either in this world or the next.

VERSE 4.41

योगसंन्यस्तकर्माणं ज्ञानसञ्छिन्नसंशयम् ।
आत्मवन्तं न कर्माणि निबध्नन्ति धनञ्जय ॥ 41 ॥

yogasamnyastakarmāṇam
jñānachinnasaṁśayam |
ātmavantam na karmāṇi
nibadnanti dhanañjaya ||

- ◆ **yoga-samnyasta-karmāṇam** – who has renounced actions through Yoga;
- ◆ **jñāna-chinna-saṁśayam** – whose doubts are rent asunder by knowledge;
- ◆ **ātmavantam** – possessed of the Self/self-possession; **na** – not; **karmāṇi** – actions;
- ◆ **nibadnanti** – bind; **dhanañjaya** – O Dhananjaya (Arjuna).

O Arjuna! Actions do not bind the man who has surrendered the fruits of karma by yoga, whose doubts are cleared by Knowledge, and who is firmly established in the Self.